

Lusha Xu

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, University of California, Riverside

Department of Economics · Riverside, CA

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EDUCATION

University of California, Riverside	Riverside, CA
<i>Ph.D. in Economics</i>	<i>Expected 2027</i>
University of California, Riverside	Riverside, CA
<i>M.S. in Statistics</i>	<i>Expected 2027</i>
California State University, Sacramento	Sacramento, CA
<i>M.S. in Economics</i>	<i>2020</i>
Guizhou University	China
<i>B.S. in Electrical and Electronics Engineering</i>	<i>2010</i>

RESEARCH AREAS

Macroeconomics · Machine Learning and Text-as-Data · Applied Econometrics · Monetary and Financial Economics

WORKING PAPERS

[1] "From Financial Reports to Macroeconomic Forecasts: An LLM-Based Approach" *Job Market Paper.*

Does the granular, qualitative information in corporate financial reports improve our understanding of aggregate economic activity? This paper bridges the gap between micro-level corporate disclosures and macroeconomic forecasting by using a Large Language Model (LLM) to perform structured information extraction from over 20,000 SEC 10-K and 10-Q filings (2001–2025). Unlike traditional dictionary-based methods, I employ a structured questionnaire approach to quantify firm-level operating conditions, labor shortages, and investment plans, deriving these metrics alongside supporting textual evidence and confidence scores. I aggregate these micro-signals into size-weighted quarterly indices to capture economy-wide trends. Using dynamic factor models and partial least squares, I demonstrate that these "textual factors" significantly improve out-of-sample GDP growth forecasts relative to standard benchmarks. The findings suggest that corporate narratives contain timely, forward-looking information that precedes traditional macroeconomic indicators, providing a scalable framework for converting unstructured text into systematic economic data.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

[1] "Central Bank Digital Currency and Bank Intermediation with Risky Loans." *Work in Progress.*

Develops a micro-founded general equilibrium model to study how interest-bearing central bank digital currency affects bank intermediation when banks make risky loans. The model examines how CBDC remuneration interacts with deposit competition, bank funding costs, lending decisions, and default risk.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, University of California, Riverside

ECON 003: Introduction to Microeconomics

Summer 2023, Summer 2025

ECON 104B: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory II Summer 2024

Teaching Assistant, University of California, Riverside

Ph.D. Core Courses

ECON 201A: Macroeconomic Theory I Fall 2022

ECON 201B: Macroeconomic Theory II Winter 2024, 2025

Undergraduate Courses

ECON 002: Introduction to Macroeconomics Spring 2023, Fall 2024

ECON 003: Introduction to Microeconomics Summer 2026

ECON 102: Intermediate Microeconomics Fall 2021

ECON 103: Intermediate Macroeconomics Winter 2022/2023, Summer 2022, Spring 2024

ECON 105A: Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory I Fall 2023

ECON 109: Forecasting in Business and Economics Spring 2025

ECON 135: The Stock Market Spring 2022, Fall 2026

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2027 2027 AEA Annual Meeting, Lightning Round, Washington, DC, USA (*scheduled*)

2026 SEA 96th Annual Meeting, Houston, TX, USA (*scheduled*)
46th International Symposium on Forecasting, Montréal, Canada
CES China Annual Conference (*online*)

2025 35th Annual Midwest Econometrics Group Conference, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, IL, USA
UC Riverside ECON-GSA Brown Bag Seminar

2024 UC Riverside Macroeconomics Reading Group

2023 UC Riverside Graduate Student Seminar

HONORS & AWARDS

Dissertation Research Grant 2026–2027

Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, University of California, Riverside 2024–2025

Teaching Assistantship, University of California, Riverside 2021–2024

GSA Conference Travel Grant, University of California, Riverside 2023–2027

Dean's Distinguished Fellowship, University of California, Riverside 2020–2021

International Student Fee Waiver, CSUS International Programs and Global Engagement 2018

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Consultant, *Graduate Quantitative Methods Center*, UC Riverside 2025–2026

Co-Organizer, *UC Riverside ECON-GSA Brown Bag Seminars* 2023–2024

Financial Manager, *Aeron Energy Technologies Co., Ltd.*, China Aug 2014–Apr 2017

Rebate Specialist, *Shanghai ICSO Co., Ltd.*, China Feb 2014–Jul 2014

Financial Analyst, *Shanghai Xingxing Finance Consulting Co., Ltd.*, China Apr 2012–Jun 2013

Referee, *Journal of Business Cycle Research*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Software	Python, R, SQL, Stata, MATLAB, $\text{\LaTeX}$
Membership	AEA · AFA · IJJ · CES
Languages	Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)

REFERENCES

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Department of Economics
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